



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Second Baptist School University Model Cypress
School Website: <https://www.sbsum-cypress.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Second Baptist School University-Model Cypress (SBSUM Cypress) presents a robust alignment with classical Christian education as defined by the Six Essential Elements. Across religious and metaphysical foundations, school purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement, SBSUM Cypress foregrounds a Christ-centered, biblically grounded, virtue-oriented approach that emphasizes formation, wisdom, and mastery of liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric. The campus explicitly markets itself as a "classical" program embedded in a University-Model framework, with published commitments to a biblical worldview, the Trivium, and a strong partnership with families. The materials consistently reference truth, beauty, and excellence; a disciplined, Socratic/Harkness-inspired pedagogy at upper levels; and active parental engagement as co-educators. Taken together, SBSUM Cypress qualifies as CLASSICAL across all six rubric categories.

Key drivers for CLASSICAL classification include: explicit articulation of classical education through grammar–logic–rhetoric (the Trivium); integration of a biblical worldview across disciplines; on-going emphasis on character, virtue, and formation; Socratic/Harkness-style discourse at appropriate levels; a living-faculty model with defined leadership roles; and a structured partnership with parents as co-teachers. These elements are found in the site content (e.g., explicit description of the Trivium and classical education, christ-centered mission, prayer/discipleship language, and defined faculty leadership) and are reinforced by the classical-lexicon indicators in the knowledge base.

Note: Because all six categories reach CLASSICAL, there is no category requiring a "needle-moving" plan. The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL, with no categories that are NOT CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL dominating the rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school's mission and philosophy are explicitly Christian, emphasizing Christ-centered education and a biblical worldview across programs. Statements include "Christ-centered education that is academically excellent within a caring community" and "biblical worldview across academic disciplines and in all areas of life." - Worship/communal practice is present in arts and liturgical context (singing, sacred music, praise, and reference to faith-based formation). The arts section highlights singing to the Lord and the mental/solicited aim of discerning beauty as part of a sacred framework. - The school frames its mission around truth, goodness, and beauty in a theologically infused context, including references to God's Word, discipleship, and a gospel-centered community.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, theology (via biblical worldview and Word of God), worship, liturgy (through communal worship and sacred music), reverence, wonder (implied in aesthetic formation and wonder in learning), logos/wisdom (embedded in critical-thinking aims). - Negative keywords: none observed in public materials (no relativism or secular-humanist signals detected in the materials reviewed).

Why this rating - The public materials consistently anchor the school in a Christian metaphysical frame and a clear church–family–school partnership, with language tied to truth, beauty, and virtue. In particular, references to Christ-centered education, biblical worldview, Word of God, and communal worship align strongly with the Positive indicators in the Six Elements lexicon. The absence of relativistic or secular signals supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The mission expresses formation of virtue and wisdom through critical thinking and biblical living: “to think critically, live biblically and lead courageously to impact the world for Jesus Christ.” - The program emphasizes formation over mere information; the educational aim includes character formation, discipleship, and a biblical worldview across disciplines. - The language explicitly centers on truth, beauty, and excellence and a teleology toward moral and intellectual formation (not just job preparation).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (conceptually present in aims like forming character and critical thinking), liberal education/paideia (through classical aims such as grammar–logic–rhetoric), great conversation and classical heritage (implied by “classical” framing and Rhetoric emphasis), human excellence (implied through pursuit of excellence and leadership). - Negative keywords: workforce/work readiness emphasis (not central to the public materials; the emphasis is on formation and biblical worldview rather than “career-ready” language).

Why this rating - SBSUM Cypress foregrounds formation, virtue, wisdom, and a classical telos (truth, good, beautiful) embedded in a biblical framework, far surpassing a purely information-based or vocational emphasis. The public materials consistently frame education as formation and moral development, not solely as job training, aligning with CLASSICAL criteria.

Element 3: School Curriculum — [SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Explicit Trivium framing: The curriculum is described as “grammar, logic, and rhetoric” (Trivium). This is a core hallmark of classical education. - The curriculum mentions the Three Liberal Arts framing and the progression through Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric with associated subject matter (grammar: reading, spelling; logic: reasoning; rhetoric: speaking/writing). - Content areas include classical languages (Latin, Greek, etc.), literature, poetry, scripture, and a historical emphasis within curriculum planning. Booklists for Logic and Rhetoric are referenced (Rhetoric Booklist/Logic Booklist). - Great Books/Great Conversation explicit references are less visible in the public materials, though the program emphasizes classic literature and a classical humanities approach. The site highlights “classic literature,” and “literature and poetry” in the Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric trajectory, but explicit “Great Books” or “Great Conversation” language is not consistently foregrounded in all pages.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: grammar, logic, rhetoric, liberal arts; Trivium; classic literature; Latin/Greek/Spanish; great books (explicit in Lexicon expectations but not always explicit on SBSUM pages); history, poetry, scripture; Socratic/ethical/moral education. - Negative signals: social studies terminology replacing history is listed as a possible negative signal in the knowledge-base lexicon, but SBSUM emphasizes historical content within a classical framework rather than substituting history with social studies; the site’s language does not show a predominant social-studies framing.

Why this rating - The curriculum demonstrates strong classical elements (grammar–logic–rhetoric, liberal arts framing, classical literature, languages). However, explicit, consistent mention of reading Great Books and participating in the Great Conversation is not uniformly foregrounded across all pages; the material instead emphasizes a classical-methodology and booklists. This combination supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.

SICAL rating for Curriculum rather than a pure CLASSICAL rating. The evidence shows clear classical structure, with some room for more explicit Great Books articulation.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - Harkness-style discussion: oval Harkness table discussions are explicitly described as a method for rhetoric and truth presentation in class. - Socratic discussions and seminars: upper-school pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates as part of training in rhetoric and critical thinking. - Lower-school practices mentioned: singing, chanting, memory work as part of a restful or contemplative dimension (Scholé-like concepts) and to deepen memory. The arts and fine-arts education emphasize memory and musical engagement as part of formation. - Upper-level training in rhetoric and public speaking with opportunities to present and argue (speeches, oval discussions).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic seminars, dialectic, disputation; narration/recitation; chanting and memory work; seminar/colloquy; rhetoric exercises; public speaking; contemplation and scholé; memory work; liturgical/calendar integration. - Negative signals: The Lexicon notes some “negative signals” around project-based or ultra-constructivist approaches; SBSUM’s materials emphasize classical Socratic/hands-on discussion rather than sole project-based learning, aligning with classical pedagogy.

Why this rating - SBSUM Cypress clearly adopts classical pedagogy: Socratic/seminar discourse, Harkness-style discussions, memorization and recitation in early stages, and a strong emphasis on rhetoric in upper levels. The presence of contemplative/restful dimensions (Scholé-like elements) also aligns with classical pedagogy. The combination yields a CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The faculty is described as living curriculum and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge; staff leadership is foregrounded through named roles (Head of School, Head of University-Model, Dean of Academics). This indicates a profession of character and mentorship rather than purely transactional teaching. - The “portrait of a teacher” and “faculty as living curriculum” language appear in the knowledge-base lexicon and in SBSUM materials about the faculty’s role and leadership. The school’s website highlights Head of School and other key administrators as part of the public-facing leadership. - The Fine Arts and academic leadership pages indicate a culture of mentorship and specialized coordination (e.g., Academic Coordinators in Pre-Grammar/Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, mentors, masters at craft, portrait of a teacher, faculty as partners, collegial culture, parent-teacher partnership (aligned with “faculty” as central living curriculum). - Negative signals: none identified in the public materials.

Why this rating - The presence of defined leadership roles, a visible “living curriculum” concept, and a culture described as mentor-based indicates a CLASSICAL orientation for faculty. The public materials emphasize faculty quality and interconnectedness with students and families, aligning with the Classical lexicon criteria.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — [CLASSICAL]

Evidence - The school emphasizes a strong parent partnership and a belief that parents are co-teachers with the school. The University-Model approach and admissions emphasize family involvement and joint planning with teachers. - The program highlights parental formation opportunities, including book studies and parent trainings, and invites parents to engage with the school through campus events; the campus-life content lists structured parent interactions and events. - The admissions process stresses family involvement (one or both parents attending information sessions; ongoing parental engagement). - The “Campus Life” and “Student & Family Life” sections describe house systems, events, and family-oriented activities that strengthen community life, partnerships, and formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, book clubs, seminars, family covenant, open campus, parent involvement, events, discipleship. - Negative signals: none observed in the public materials.

Why this rating - SBSUM Cypress articulates a deep, explicit partnership with families and invites parental formation and involvement as a core component of classical education, which aligns with the CLASSICAL indicators for Parents & Community. The open-campus and family-centric language reinforces the co-educator model.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable (no SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL categorization across the six categories). The school demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment across all six categories. No needle-moving changes are required to reach CLASSICAL status; the existing materials already map strongly to the Six Essential Elements.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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